

STRATEGIC PLAYER VALUATION IN THE IPL

MAXIMIZING FRANCHISE ROI VIA INFLATION-ADJUSTED ANALYTICS

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255,759

Deliveries Analyzed

₹18.5 Cr

Max Marquee Salary

186.5

Avg Team Score (2024)

0.24

Cost Correlation

Business Context & The 'Winner's Curse'

Franchises operate under strict salary caps but frequently overpay for marquee players based on raw aggregate stats (e.g., total runs), ignoring situational efficiency.

OBJECTIVE: Identify market inefficiencies to build resilient, championship squads at a fraction of the market cost.

Chart 1: Top-Order Visibility Commands the Highest Premium

The auction market heavily favors top-order visibility, with Opening Batters commanding the highest premium at ₹6.02 Cr. Conversely, Pure Specialists like Middle-Order Batters and Pure Bowlers offer high-leverage value at a steep discount of ₹2.01 to ₹2.44 Cr.

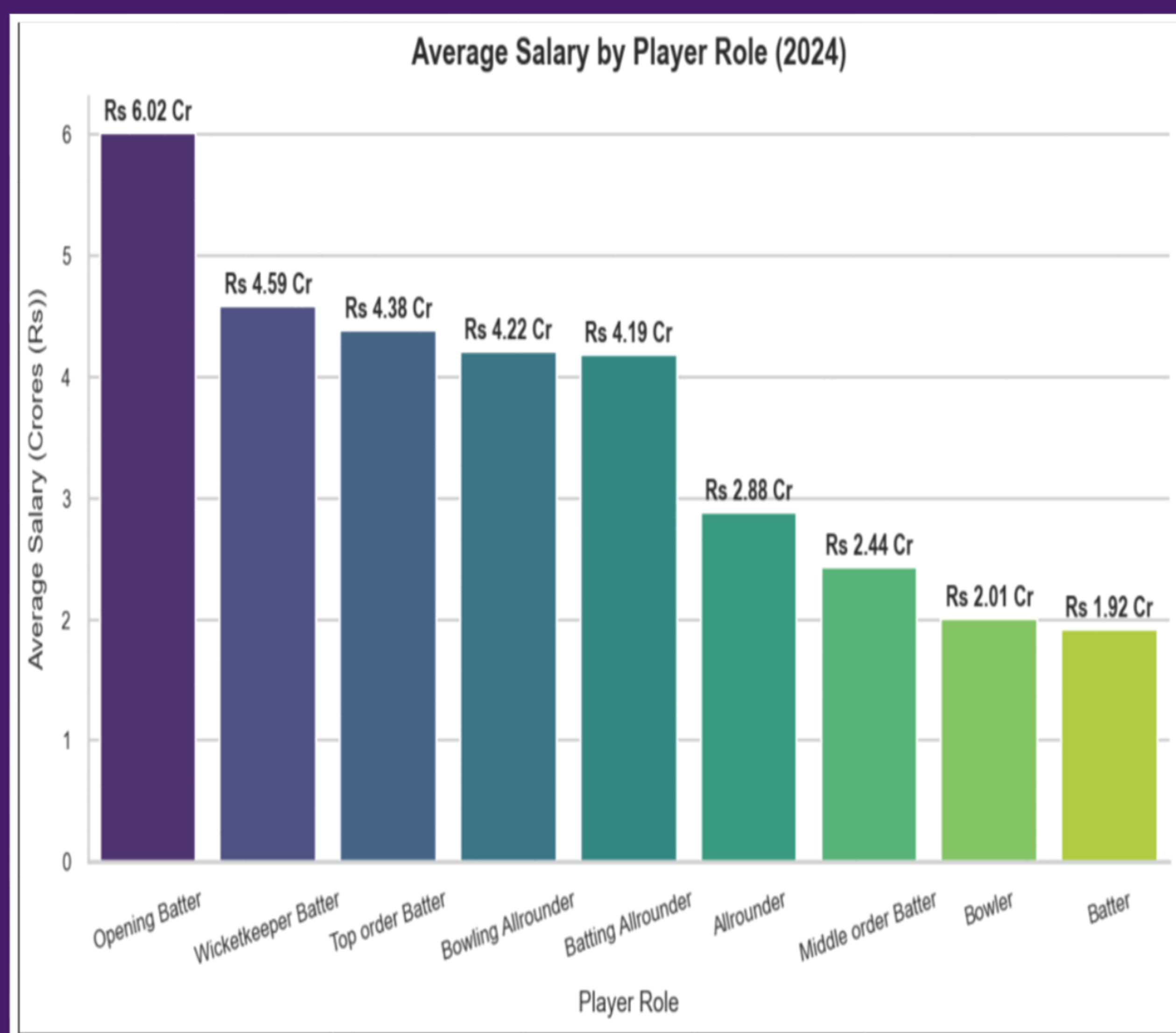


Chart 2: 17-Year Strike Rate

While Death Overs consistently remain the undisputed peak of scoring velocity across the league's history, early Powerplay aggression has evolved rapidly in the modern era to officially surpass Middle Over run rates.

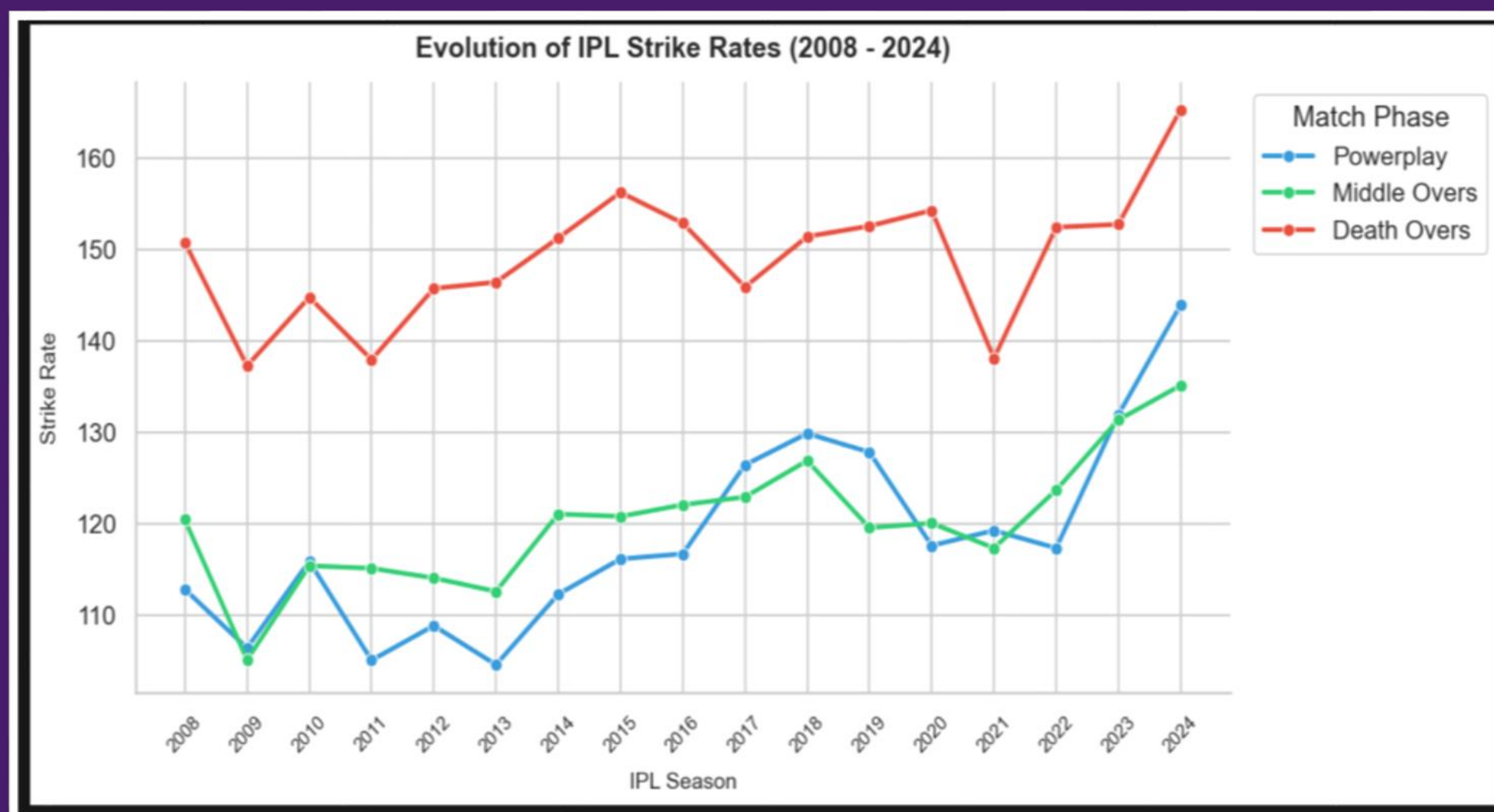


Chart 3: Run Inflation is Driven by Volume, Not Reckless Risk

Average team scores have exploded from the 140s in early seasons to over 186 runs, yet wicket-loss rates remain perfectly static, proving this run inflation is driven by volume efficiency rather than reckless risk.

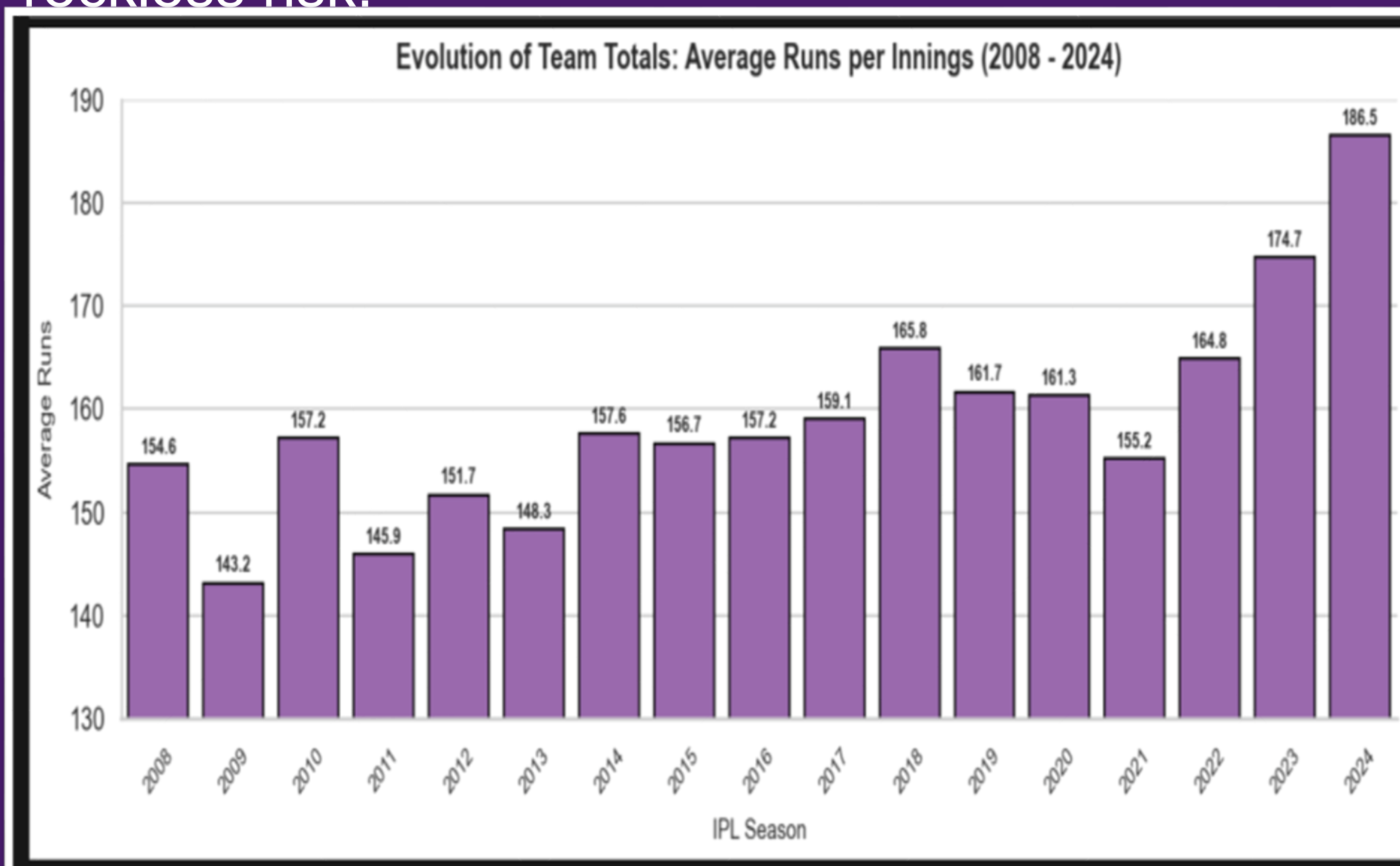
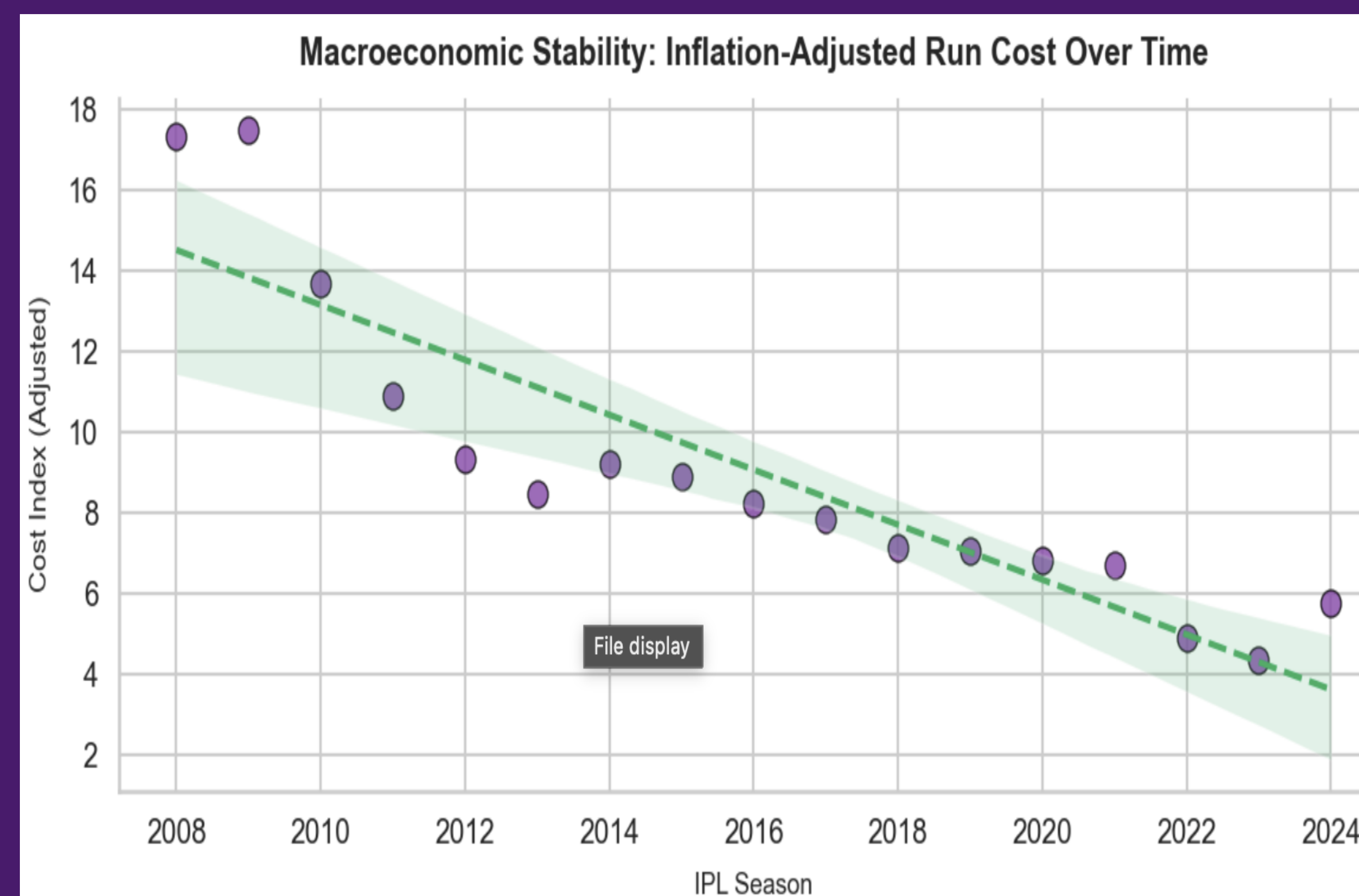


Chart 4: Inflation-Adjusted Cost

When adjusted for historical macroeconomics, the financial premium on player production remains remarkably steady. Players are not drastically overvalued; rather, the skyrocketing auction numbers simply reflect natural currency expansion over time.



Strategic Recommendation: "Stars & Scrubs":

- **Buy Top-Order Impact:** Pay the premium for elite Opening and Wicketkeeper Batters to dominate fielding-restricted Powerplay scoring.
- **Exploit Inefficiencies:** Avoid mid-tier all-rounders. Anchor the lower order with highly undervalued Pure Specialists (Middle-Order Batters & Bowlers) for cost-effective death-over execution.
- **Ignore Artificial Inflation:** Rising auction prices reflect natural currency expansion, not decoupled player value. Bid confidently knowing inflation-adjusted costs are completely stable.